CLARK COLLEGE · FALL 2026 · ITEM 36001

CTEC 121 Introduction to Programming and Problem Solving

Scarpelli Hall Room 125 · Mondays & Wednesdays, 10:00 AM – 12:20 PM
September 21 – December 4, 2026 · 5 credits · **$0 materials**

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Start here

If you read one part of this document, read this one.

WHAT IT COSTS	**$0.** No textbook, no lab fees, no access codes.
WHEN THINGS ARE DUE	**Sundays at 11:59 PM Pacific** — and most work stays open three more days, through **Wednesday at 11:59 PM**, at full credit. The exceptions are anything taken in class and the final project.
TIME TO BUDGET	About **10 hours a week**. Class is 4 hours 40 minutes of that, so plan on roughly **5–6 hours on your own**.
HOW TO REACH ME	**Slack first.** I reply within 24 hours on weekdays.
THE TWO BIG ONES	The **final exam** — in class, **Monday, November 30**. And the **final project** — due **Friday, December 4**, a firm date, presented during finals week.
THE AI RULE	The CS50 Duck (cs50.ai) is always allowed. No other AI may write, complete, or suggest code you turn in — though using one to explain a concept or an error message is fine, as long as you say so in a comment. You'll write your code in **cs50.dev**, which already has AI autocomplete turned off.
IF YOU FALL BEHIND	Message me *before* the deadline. We'll set a new date. This is a real offer, not a trap. If an emergency makes reaching me beforehand impossible, tell me as soon as you can.

Your grade: Participation & collaboration 25% · Problem sets 20% · Final project 20% · Midterm 10% · Quizzes 10% · Final exam 10% · Labs 5%

Five things to do in week one

1. Log into Canvas (clarkcollege.instructure.com) and read the announcements at the top.
2. Work through **Module 0** — it sets up your coding environment, Slack, and GitHub.
3. Join the class **Slack**. No invite? Message me.
4. **Open cs50.dev** and sign in with your GitHub account. That's where you'll write your code.

⑤ Start **Module 1**: Lab 0, Problem Set 0, Collaborative Assignment 0.

The course at a glance

Course	CTEC 121, Introduction to Programming and Problem Solving · Item 36001
When and where	Mondays and Wednesdays, 10:00 AM – 12:20 PM · Scarpelli Hall, Room 125
Quarter dates	Monday, September 21 – Friday, December 4, 2026 · Finals week December 7–10
Sessions we lose	Wednesday, November 11 (Veterans Day) and Wednesday, November 25 (Thanksgiving). **Weeks 8 and 10 have one session instead of two.**
Last day to withdraw	Thursday, December 3, 2026
Credits & time	5 credits · about 10 hours a week total — 4 hours 40 minutes in class, roughly 5–6 hours on your own
Modality	In person
Course site	Canvas `(clarkcollege.instructure.com)`
Materials cost	$0
Prerequisites	Eligibility for ENGL& 101 or PTWR 135, and a "C" or better in PTCS 110 or a math course with a prerequisite of MATH 30 or higher

What the catalog says: fundamental concepts related to designing and writing computer programs and procedures. Topics include problem-solving techniques, program design, coding, debugging, testing, and documentation. The course stresses concepts common to many programming languages and introduces Python. It meets general education requirements for transfer degrees.

What that means in practice: you will learn to take a problem you don't yet know how to solve, break it apart, and write Python that solves it. You'll do that through labs, problem sets, quizzes, group work, and a final project of your own design.

About CS50P: this course is aligned with CS50 at Harvard University's free CS50P "Introduction to Programming with Python" `(cs50.harvard.edu/python)`, so you can work through that course alongside this one if you want to. That's entirely optional — it isn't required, and it isn't part of your grade.

Meet your instructor

Name	Bruce Elgort — please just call me Bruce
Email	belgort@clark.edu
Cell	(360) 992-2951 — call or text
Office	Scarpelli Hall Room 127 and Virtual (Zoom), plus before and after every class
Student hours	On Zoom — days, times, and link are in Canvas. If none of those times work for you, message me on Slack and we'll find one that does.
Best way to reach me	**Slack.** Email works too; phone and Canvas messages reach me as well.
Response time	Within 24 hours Monday–Friday; by Monday evening for weekend messages.

I've taught web development and programming at Clark for 14 years, and I still get a kick out of watching someone's first working program run. Outside of class I tinker with new and emerging technology, usually with an extra-large cup of coffee nearby. In industry I'm known for co-developing Elguji's IdeaJam software.

I earned a Bachelor of Engineering in Electrical Engineering from the Stevens Institute of Technology in 1985, and a Master's in Engineering Management from NYU's Tandon School of Engineering in 1990.

> **IF I GO QUIET**
>
> If a full day goes by and you haven't heard back from me, message me again.
> Something went astray. You are not bothering me.

What I believe about teaching

> *"Everyone you meet is fighting a battle you know nothing about. Be kind always."*

- Learning is slow. It takes time and repetition, and that is normal — not a sign you're bad at this.
- You'll gain far more from correcting your own answer than from me correcting it for you.
- **I'm not an answer key.** If I just told you "yes, that's right," you'd never build the ability to judge your own work — and there are no answer keys in a real job.
- Knowing *why* your answer is right matters as much as the answer.
- Asking questions is the single best thing you can do for yourself and your group.
- Every activity I assign, I've worked through myself, more than once, before you see it.

What this class is like

Why Python

Python is the friendliest first language there is. The syntax stays out of your way, it pushes you toward writing clean code, and it's genuinely useful the moment you learn it — websites, data analysis, automation, machine learning. It's also one of the most in-demand languages in the job market, which doesn't hurt.

Seeing square brackets and words like `function` , `range` , or `if` on your screen can be intimidating at first. That fades faster than you'd think. Coding is really just solving problems in small, careful steps, and that's a skill you already have.

How we spend our time

We'll use lectures, videos, group activities, hands-on labs, peer critiques, and discussion. You're expected to take part in class discussions and exercises, and I'd love it if you brought your own real-world examples into them.

Each week you'll work through a Canvas module: readings, videos, labs, a problem set, and a collaborative assignment. Most weeks also open with a short in-class quiz on the module you just finished — eight across the quarter, on the dates in the schedule. Modules open on Sundays, except Modules 0 and 1, which open on the first day of class.

Want to work ahead? Message me on Slack and I'll unlock material early. This is especially worth doing if you're also working through CS50P and wanting to earn the CS50 certificate.

Attendance

A meaningful portion of your participation grade is earned in the room, so please plan to attend both sessions each week.

- **If you have to miss class**, let me know on Slack when you can. You're still responsible for that week's module and its deadlines.
- Missing class doesn't automatically cost you points. In-class exercises and the quizzes are the exceptions: for exercises there's a make-up you can do on your own (see How participation works), and one missed quiz is covered by the dropped-score policy.
- **If your attendance starts slipping for any reason** — illness, work, caregiving, anything — tell me early. Almost every problem is solvable in Week 3 and much harder to solve in Week 10.
- Absences for reasons of faith or conscience are accommodated.

If you need an accommodation

I want this course to work for you. Start with Clark's steps for requesting accommodations (www.clark.edu/campus-life/…) through the Disability Access Center, then talk to me about what you need in this class specifically. Full DAC contact details and testing procedures are under College policies.

What you'll need

Cost: $0. No textbook, no lab fees. All course materials are free, including resources aligned with CS50 at Harvard University.

WHAT	NOTES
A computer	Windows, macOS, or Linux — and a Chromebook works too, because you'll code in the browser.
cs50.dev	Our coding environment. It runs in your browser, requires no installation, and comes with AI autocomplete already switched off. Sign in with GitHub.
Internet access	Plus a backup plan for when your computer or connection fails. Clark's computer labs are listed in Module 0.
A web browser	Chrome, Firefox, Edge, or Safari.
Slack	Our class communication hub. Setup instructions in Module 0.
A GitHub account	Free — it's how you sign into cs50.dev. Setup in Module 0; an existing account is fine.
Free software	Anything else you need is free, and Canvas tells you exactly how to set it up.
The CS50 Duck	cs50.ai — your approved AI helper.

You'll also need to be comfortable using Canvas (tutorials here (www.clark.edu/academics/eLearning)) and searching online for answers. Canvas works on phones for reading, but you'll need a real computer to write and submit code.

A note on the three outside accounts

Slack, GitHub, and cs50.ai are run by companies other than Clark, so a few things are worth knowing:

- You may use a display name instead of your full legal name. Just tell me which account is yours.

- Don’t post personal or sensitive information — yours or anyone else’s — in Slack or in a public GitHub repository.
- Each service sets its own privacy and accessibility terms, which Clark doesn’t control.
- **Would rather not create one of these accounts?** Tell me in week one. There’s an alternative for each, and using it won’t affect your grade.

For Microsoft and Canvas accessibility and privacy details, see Clark’s eLearning policies page (www.clark.edu/academics/…). As a Clark student you can also download Microsoft Office for free (www.clark.edu/its/…) — not required here, but useful elsewhere.

How you’ll be graded

CATEGORY	WEIGHT	WHAT IT IS
Discussion, participation & collaboration	25%	Weekly reflections, in-class exercises, and nine collaborative assignments
Problem sets	20%	One per module, due Sunday
Final project	20%	Assigned Week 5, due Friday, December 4 — firm, no three-day window — presented during finals week
Midterm	10%	In class, Wednesday, October 28 — the Week 6 checkpoint, on paper
Quizzes	10%	Eight across the quarter, in class on paper — lowest score dropped
Final exam	10%	In class, Monday, November 30 — cumulative, on paper
Labs	5%	One or more per module, due Sunday

> THE DEADLINE RULE, ONCE
>
> Everything is due **Sunday at 11:59 PM Pacific** and stays open for **three more days — through Wednesday at 11:59 PM — at full credit**. Two things sit outside it: anything taken in class, and the final project.

The details

- **Problem sets** — one per module. Close three days after the due date.
- **Labs** — one or more per module. Close three days after the due date.

- **Quizzes — eight across the quarter, taken in class on paper.** About ten minutes at the start of class, closed-book. They are short on purpose: the point is a regular, honest check that the code you turned in is code you can actually write.
  - **Your lowest quiz score is dropped**, and that drop *is* the make-up policy — it covers one missed quiz, not several.
  - **When:** each quiz is given at the start of the **first class session after that module's Sunday due date.** In practice that means Mondays — **October 5, 12, 19 and 26, and November 2, 9, 16 and 23.** They're marked on the schedule below, and I'll remind you the session before. You will never walk into a surprise quiz.
  - **The three-day window doesn't move the quiz.** Using those extra days on an assignment is fine — the quiz still happens on its date. So if you're going to run late on something, run late on the assignment, not on the studying.
  - **What's on it:** the module whose work was due that Sunday — material you have already worked through and turned in. Never something you haven't done yet.
  - **Module 8 (object-oriented programming) has no quiz.** It's due the night before the final exam, so OOP is assessed on the exam instead.

- **Midterm** — in class on **Wednesday, October 28** (Week 6). About 50 minutes, on paper, closed-book, covering Weeks 1–5: functions, variables, conditionals, loops, and exception handling. Same format as the final exam, so it doubles as your dress rehearsal for it.
  - It lands five weeks before the **December 3** withdrawal deadline on purpose. You get a real, graded signal about where you stand while you still have room to act on it.
  - Like the final exam, it has **no three-day window**. If you cannot be there on October 28, talk to me *before* that date — or as soon as you can, if an emergency makes that impossible.

- **Final project** — assigned in Week 5, due **Friday, December 4 at 11:59 PM**, and presented to the class during **finals week (December 7–10)**. You submit first and present after, so you're never building and presenting in the same week. It includes a short written **ethics and limitations** piece: what ethical questions your program raises, and what it can't — or shouldn't — do. That part is graded, not optional.
  - **December 4 is firm — it's the only take-home deadline without the three-day window.** Presentations begin December 7, so I need every project in hand before then. If something is going to stop you, talk to me before December 4, or as soon as you can if an emergency makes that impossible.

- **Final exam** — in class on **Monday, November 30**. It's cumulative, on paper, and closed-book: tracing code, predicting output, and writing short functions by hand. You've been doing all three since Week 1.
  - **Like the quizzes and the midterm, it has no three-day window.** If something will keep you from being there on November 30, contact me *before* that date — or as soon as you can, if an emergency makes that impossible — and we'll arrange something.
  - **Testing accommodations through DAC?** DAC needs at least five business days' notice for each exam, so set up both the midterm (October 28) and the final (November 30) in the first two weeks. November 30 is the tight one: Thanksgiving break eats most of that week, so book it by **Friday, November 20** at the latest. For the short weekly quizzes, tell me in the first two weeks — or as soon as the need comes up — and we will arrange your accommodation in class.
  - I'll post a review guide and a practice exam in Canvas by Week 9, so you can prepare before the break rather than during it.

Rubrics for every assessment live in the relevant Canvas module.

How participation works

This is your biggest category, so here is exactly how you earn it.

COMPONENT	SHARE OF YOUR FINAL GRADE
In-class participation and group work	12%
Collaborative assignments (nine across the quarter)	8%
Weekly written/video reflections and discussion posts in Canvas	5%

- **Graded on effort, not correctness.** Show your reasoning and you get full credit even when the answer turns out to be wrong. A blank or one-word submission doesn't.
- Reflections and collaborative assignments can be done outside class, so missing a session doesn't cost you those points.
- **In-class participation** is the one part that needs you in the room. Miss a class? Message me on Slack and I'll give you an equivalent to do on your own.
- **If speaking up in class or working in groups is hard for you** — including as part of a DAC accommodation — tell me in the first two weeks, or as soon as the need comes up. There's a written alternative for every in-class component. Setting it up is routine and completely unremarkable.

Grading scale

PERCENT	GRADE	PERCENT	GRADE
94–100%	A	80–83%	B-
90–93%	A-	77–79%	C+
87–89%	B+	70–76%	C
84–86%	B	60–69%	D
		Below 60%	F

- **A "C" or better** is required for this course to count toward a degree or certificate.
- **Rounding:** final percentages round to the nearest whole number, so 89.5% becomes 90% and earns an A-. I don't round past that. What I *will* do is talk with you early about how to move your grade — please don't wait until Week 11 to ask.
- **Incompletes:** an "I" is possible only if you've completed most of the course in good standing and something unexpected stops you from finishing. It takes a written agreement between us with a deadline, and it isn't a substitute for withdrawing.

Late work

One rule: work is due Sunday at 11:59 PM and stays open three more days at full credit.

- No penalty, no permission needed, no explanation required inside that window. It's built into every regular take-home deadline.
- Canvas will stamp those submissions "late." **Ignore the label** — it doesn't affect your grade.
- **Two things sit outside the window.** First, **anything taken in class** — the weekly quizzes, the midterm (October 28), and the final exam (November 30) all happen in the room. For quizzes, the dropped lowest score covers a miss; for the midterm or the final, talk to me *before* the date. Second, the **final project**: December 4 is firm, because presentations begin December 7.

- **When something bigger is going on** — illness, work, family, a genuinely brutal week — contact me *before* the deadline and we'll set a new date. I grant these. I just need to hear from you — and if an emergency makes reaching me beforehand impossible, tell me as soon as you are able.

Work that lands weeks or months late has lost most of its value, because it no longer connects to anything the class is doing. That's the reason for the window, and it's why talking to me early works so much better than going quiet.

Feedback

I aim to return feedback within a week of the due date, while the material is still fresh. If you want extra help, reach out and we'll find a time.

Weekly schedule

Subject to change — I'll announce any updates in class, on Canvas, and on Slack.

WEEK	DATES	TOPIC	DUE THAT WEEK
1–2	Sept 21 – Oct 2	Course intro · Setting up your environment · Functions and variables	**Sunday, October 4** Lab 0 · Problem Set 0 · Collaborative 0
3	Oct 5 – 9	Conditionals · **Quiz 0 in class Mon Oct 5**	**Sunday, October 11** Lab 1 · Problem Set 1 · Collaborative 1
4	Oct 12 – 16	Loops · **Quiz 1 in class Mon Oct 12**	**Sunday, October 18** Lab 2 · Problem Set 2 · Collaborative 2
5	Oct 19 – 23	Exception handling · **Quiz 2 in class Mon Oct 19** · **Final project assigned**	**Sunday, October 25** Lab 3 · Problem Set 3 · Collaborative 3
6	Oct 26 – 30	Libraries · **Quiz 3 in class Mon Oct 26** · **Midterm in class Wed Oct 28**	**Sunday, November 1** Lab 4 · Problem Set 4 · Collaborative 4
7	Nov 2 – 6	Unit tests · **Quiz 4 in class Mon Nov 2**	**Sunday, November 8** Lab 5 · Problem Set 5 · Collaborative 5
8	Nov 9 – 13	File input/output · **Quiz 5 in class Mon Nov 9** · *no class Wed Nov 11*	**Sunday, November 15** Lab 6 · Problem Set 6 · Collaborative 6
9	Nov 16 – 20	Regular expressions · **Quiz 6 in class Mon Nov 16**	**Sunday, November 22** Lab 7 · Problem Set 7 · Collaborative 7
10	Nov 23 – 27	Object-oriented programming · **Quiz 7 in class Mon Nov 23** · *no class Wed Nov 25*	**Sunday, November 29** Lab 8 · Problem Set 8 · Collaborative 8
11	Nov 30 – Dec 4	**Final exam Mon Nov 30** · *project work Wed*	**Friday, December 4** Final project. Firm: the only take-home deadline without the window.
Finals	Dec 7 – 10	Final project presentations	Present your project — schedule posted in Canvas

The bold date in the last column is the deadline — 11:59 PM Pacific that day. Everything under it stays open three more days at full credit, through the following **Wednesday at 11:59 PM**. Quizzes, the midterm and the final exam are taken in class on the dates shown in the Topic column, so they aren't part of that window — and neither is the final project.

From Week 5 on, you're also working on your final project alongside each week's module.

> **PLAN AROUND THE END OF THE QUARTER**
>
> Week 10 has only one class session, it's the week of Thanksgiving, and the final exam is the Monday right after the break. Module 8's work is due **Sunday, November 29 — the night before the exam.** Finish it *before* the weekend if you possibly can. The three-day window does technically carry it to Wednesday, December 2, but don't plan on that: December 2 is two days before your final project is due, and you'd be writing new code instead of finishing it. Treat the window as a safety net here, not a schedule. Don't plan to study over the holiday either: do your reviewing during Week 9 and the first half of Week 10, when the review guide is already posted. Week 8 also has a single session. This stretch is where students get squeezed every quarter, and it's the one part of this course I'd tell you to get out in front of.

Course agreements

Communication

Slack is the fastest way to reach me, and it's where you can ask questions, help each other, and share things you find. Everyone gets an invitation; if yours didn't arrive, contact me. Check Canvas announcements whenever you log in — they're at the top of the page.

On netiquette: there are real people on the other side of every message. Use the same courtesy online that you'd use face to face.

AI guidelines

AI is part of this course. It's also the easiest way to accidentally skip the learning you're paying for. So this policy is about what you must be able to **do**, not about a list of banned brand names.

The standard: everything you submit must be code whose decisions you can explain, and that you can change on your own, without AI help. If you couldn't talk me through why it works and modify it when asked, it isn't yours to submit. The weekly quizzes, the midterm, the final exam, and your project presentation all check exactly that — which is why leaning on AI now mostly shows up as a bad grade later.

Always allowed	The **CS50 Duck Debugger** (cs50.ai). It's built to ask you questions instead of handing you answers. That's the point.
Allowed for learning, with a note	Asking any AI to explain a concept, unpack an error message, or summarize documentation — the same way you'd use a search engine or a textbook. If it shaped what you turned in, say so in a code comment, the same as any other source. What stays off-limits is letting it write the code.
Not allowed on submitted work	Any other AI that suggests, completes, or generates code — ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, and the AI features now baked into editors and browsers. Submitting AI-written code is treated like submitting another person's code.

Where you'll write code	**cs50.dev**, CS50's browser-based environment. Copilot and inline AI autocomplete are already turned off there, which is one less thing for you to get wrong. If you'd rather work in your own editor, that's fine — but then it's on you to make sure no AI completion is running.
When AI is assigned	Some assignments will ask you to use AI beyond the Duck. Those will say so explicitly, name the allowed tools, and may ask you to turn in your prompts.

If I think AI wrote your code, I'll ask you to walk me through it — what a section does, why you did it that way, how you'd change it. That's a conversation, and it happens before any finding is made. I don't use AI-detection software to assign grades; those detectors are unreliable and I won't grade you on one.

Not sure whether something's allowed? Ask me on Slack before you submit. Asking has never once counted against a student.

Academic honesty

My approach here is best described as **reasonable**. Working with other people genuinely helps you learn. But there's a line between getting help and handing in someone else's work, and this is where it sits.

The essence of everything you submit must be your own. The general rule when asking for help: *you may show your work to others, but you may not look at theirs.*

This table is about take-home work you turn in as your own — labs, problem sets, and your final project. It does **not** describe the quizzes, the midterm or the final exam: those are closed-book and taken in class, so none of the help below is available during them. **The collaborative assignments are the deliberate exception:** on those, working together, reading each other's code, and turning in a joint product *is* the assignment. Each one tells you who you're working with and what you may share. If an assignment doesn't say it's collaborative, treat it as individual and use the table below.

THIS IS FINE	THIS IS NOT
Talking a problem through with a classmate in words, and citing that conversation in a comment	Looking at a classmate's solution before you've submitted your own
Showing your code to someone so they can help you find your bug	Sharing your solution with someone who's stuck on it
Helping a classmate debug *after* you've submitted that part yourself	Splitting an **individual** assignment with someone and combining the pieces
Whiteboarding an approach in diagrams or pseudocode	Whiteboarding in actual code
Borrowing a few lines you found online and citing where they came from	Searching for, or asking for, outright solutions to assigned work
Using the web to learn more, look things up, or solve technical trouble	Copying someone's solution and basing yours on it
Working with a tutor who helps you learn	Paying anyone for work you submit
Using the CS50 Duck · asking another AI to explain a concept or an error message, and citing it in a comment	Using any other AI to write, complete, or suggest code you submit
Reusing your own work from *this* course	Reusing work from another course, or giving your solutions to anyone — this quarter or a future one

Also not okay: using an account that isn't yours, manipulating scores, and finding a flaw in Canvas or an autograder that affects grades without telling me.

Cite your sources. If you bring in code or a technique from outside our lessons, say where it came from in a code comment. Same idea as citing a source in an essay: Clark Libraries' plagiarism guide (clark.libguides.com/c.php) is a good primer.

If something crosses the line, consequences follow Clark's academic dishonesty policy: no credit on the assessment, a failing course grade for serious or repeated violations, and possible referral to Student Conduct. You have the right to respond before any finding is made and to appeal through the division chair.

When in doubt, ask me first — in writing, so we both have the answer. Asking in good faith never counts against you.

Classroom norms

- Complete each week's module — readings, assignments, and discussions — by the due date.
- Take part in class discussions and exercises, and bring your own experiences into them.
- Be a courteous member of the room and don't get in the way of anyone else's learning.
- Academic and intellectual honesty are expected at all times.
- Tell me as early as you can about anything that affects your ability to take part fully.

Recording class sessions

You're welcome to record class for your own study use — no permission needed. Please don't post or share recordings, screenshots, or classmates' work outside this class. People share half-finished code and honest confusion in a programming class, and that only works if the room feels safe. If DAC has approved recording as an accommodation, you never need to explain that to anyone. If I record a session, I'll say so and post it in Canvas.

Changes to this syllabus

This is a plan, not a contract, and I may adjust it during the quarter. Anything that affects your grade or your deadlines gets announced in Canvas and on Slack, and I'll post an updated syllabus.

Withdrawing from the course

The last day to withdraw is **Thursday, December 3, 2026**. If you stop attending without formally withdrawing, you'll receive an "F." Deadlines are on Clark's Important Dates & Deadlines (www.clark.edu/about/…) page.

Before you withdraw, please talk to me. There's often an option you haven't considered.

What you'll be able to do by the end

- **C1.** Show how computer operations and algorithmic thinking are applied to solve problems.
- **C2.** Demonstrate working knowledge of fundamental computer concepts and iteration.
- **C3.** Identify problems, solve them algorithmically, and write programs that address them.
- **C4.** Discuss ethics in computing and the limitations of what computing can do.

OUTCOME	TAUGHT IN	GRADED THROUGH
C1	Weeks 1–4: functions, variables, conditionals, loops	Labs 0–2 · Problem Sets 0–2 · Quizzes 0–2 · Midterm · Final exam · Final project

OUTCOME	TAUGHT IN	GRADED THROUGH
C2	Weeks 3–7: loops, exceptions, libraries, unit tests	Labs 1–5 · Problem Sets 1–5 · Quizzes 1–5 · Midterm · Final exam
C3	Every week, most heavily Weeks 5–10	Problem sets · Collaborative assignments · Final exam · Final project
C4	Raised in Week 1, revisited as topics come up	The final project's **ethics and limitations** component

College-wide abilities and program outcomes

College-wide abilities. Clark identifies six abilities at the foundation of its educational emphasis: communication, critical thinking and problem solving, information and technology, effective citizenship, life-long learning, and global/multicultural awareness. This course emphasizes **information technology**, **critical thinking and problem solving**, and **communication**.

Program outcomes (Web Development AAT). As an introductory programming course, CTEC 121 contributes directly to **P1** (web foundations), **P4** (web development), **P5** (professional practices), **P6** (written communication), **P7** (interpersonal skills), and **P8** (explaining a strategy for a quantitative problem). P2 (web media) and P3 (web design) are developed in other courses in the degree.

College policies

These apply across Clark College. They're collapsed so you can find the one you need.

ADA accommodations

The Disability Access Center (DAC) coordinates accommodations for students with disabilities and with temporary health conditions, including a temporary injury or pregnancy. **All accommodations must be approved through DAC first.** Request them by following the steps at www.clark.edu/dac.

Phone	360-992-2314 · ASL video phone 360-991-0901
Email	dac@clark.edu · testing questions: DACtesting@clark.edu
Location	Penguin Union Building (PUB) 002

Two things students often miss: **accommodations must be requested every term** in myAccess `(www.clark.edu/dac/myaccess.php)`, and **exams at DAC must be scheduled by you** with at least five business days' notice.

Once your accommodations are set, contact me so we can talk about this course specifically. If you have emergency medical information I should know, tell me by the end of week one.

Non-discrimination

Clark College prohibits discrimination on the basis of race, color, national origin, age, perceived or actual physical or mental disability, pregnancy, genetic information, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, marital status, creed, religion, honorably discharged veteran or military status, citizenship, immigration status, or use of a trained guide dog or service animal. Harassment is a form of discrimination.

To file a formal grievance: Human Resources, 1933 Fort Vancouver Way, Baird Hall 133 · 360-992-2105 · hr@clark.edu.

Title IX and sexual misconduct

If you or someone you care about has been affected by sexual misconduct, you are not alone, and people here can help — to listen, to explain your options, and to help keep you safe. There's no "right way" to feel and no single right thing to do.

- Campus and community resources (www.clark.edu/about/…)
- Reporting options (www.clark.edu/about/…)
- Title IX at Clark (www.clark.edu/about/…)
- Personal safety and helping a friend (www.clark.edu/about/…)
- Counseling and Health Center (www.clark.edu/campus-life/…)

Student rights and responsibilities

Clark's Student Rights and Responsibilities page (www.clark.edu/about/…) covers freedom of access to education, absence for reasons of faith or conscience, FERPA, and emergency and health information.

If you'll be absent for reasons of faith, just let me know — no explanation needed beyond that.

Academic dishonesty

Academic dishonesty usually happens when students are stressed and out of time, not because they set out to cheat. Two main forms:

- **Plagiarism** — not crediting or properly citing sources for your work.
- **Cheating** — giving or getting help that isn't allowed on an assignment.

How to stay clear of it: ask me when you're unsure, cite your sources, turn in original work, don't submit the same work in two classes without permission, and never fabricate results or citations.

Consequences: a failing grade on the assignment or, in extreme cases, the course. Students may also be referred to the Student Conduct Office, which can require learning activities or, in extreme or repeated cases, dismissal from a program. To challenge a finding, you can file a grade appeal starting with the division chair.

Emergencies

SITUATION	WHAT TO DO
Inclement weather or closure	Check www.clark.edu or call 360-992-2000 first — those are the official sources.
Emergency alerts	Register your phone and email at flashalert.net (www.flashalert.net). Do this now, not later.
Fire alarm	Leave by the nearest exit (maps are in the hallways), take belongings only if it's safe, stay at least 50 feet from the building, and don't re-enter until told.
Escort to your car	Campus Security: 360-992-2133.

Parking lots are identified by color and number — use those to tell security or emergency responders where you are.

Where to get help

Asking for help early is the single strongest predictor of finishing this course well. Please use these.

COURSE HELP

IF YOU NEED	GO TO
Help with the material or an assignment	Message me on Slack, or come to student hours
A second set of eyes on your code	The CS50 Duck (cs50.ai), or ask in Slack
Free tutoring	Clark Tutoring Services (www.clark.edu/campus-life/…) in person or on Zoom · eTutoringOnline.org
Research and citation help	Clark librarians (library.clark.edu) — in person or by chat (library.clark.edu/content/ask-librarian)

TECH HELP

IF YOU NEED	GO TO
Canvas, software, or account trouble	Tech Hub (www.clark.edu/its/…) — Scarpelli Hall 135 · techhub@clark.edu · 360-992-2010
To report a Canvas problem	The **Help** button in Canvas → “Report a Problem” (replies come to your Clark Gmail) · Canvas Student Guide (community.instructure.com/en/…)
A computer to work on	Open computer labs (www.clark.edu/its/…), including weekends
To borrow a laptop	Laptop request form (www.clark.edu/its/…)
Account setup	All four Clark student accounts (www.clark.edu/its/…) · student email (www.clark.edu/its/…) · ctcLink (www.clark.edu/its/…)

LIFE HELP

IF YOU NEED	GO TO
Food, housing, or financial help	Basic Needs Hub (www.clark.edu/campus-life/…) — basicneeds@clark.edu · 360-992-2766 · Gaiser Hall 216 · intake form (forms.office.com/r/QYMvHDdhxF)
Groceries	Penguin Pantry (www.clark.edu/campus-life/…) — monthly food boxes; contact Cath Busha, Dean of Student Engagement (cbusha@clark.edu)
Physical or mental health support	Counseling and Health Center (www.clark.edu/campus-life/…)
Help navigating college itself	Student Success Coaches (www.clark.edu/campus-life/…) — PUB 002 or Zoom
Academic planning	Advising Services (www.clark.edu/enroll/advising-services) — schedule an appointment (www.clark.edu/enroll/…)
Career and job help	Career Services (www.clark.edu/enroll/careers/index.php) — 360-992-2902 · careerservices@clark.edu
Veteran support	Veterans Center of Excellence (www.clark.edu/campus-life/…) — PUB 015 · 360-992-2073
Community and belonging	Office of People and Culture (www.clark.edu/campus-life/…) and The Diversity Center (www.clark.edu/campus-life/…) — everyone welcome

> **IF MONEY IS TIGHT**
>
> If you’re having trouble affording food or don’t have stable housing, please contact the Basic Needs Hub — and if you’re comfortable telling me, do. I may know of resources you haven’t found yet, and it stays between us.

More at Clark Students (www.clark.edu/current/index.php), including C-Tran transit (www.c-tran.com) and campus maps (www.clark.edu/about/…).

Programming is learned by doing it badly, repeatedly, until it clicks. Everyone’s code breaks. Everyone gets stuck. The students who do well in here aren’t the ones who never get stuck — they’re the ones who ask sooner.

So ask. I’m on Slack, and I’m glad you’re here.

— Bruce